

DON'T GET FORKED

A tabletop game of monsters, mischief and pitchforks

Once a year, the monsters go shopping.

VERSION 0.1

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PLAY IT ONLINE

A companion game system for Foundry Virtual Tabletop:
github.com/PainHog/DontGetForked

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PART ONE

Playing the Game

*The Entities, the dice, the raid, Suspicion, the chase and how
the year went: everything the players need at the table.*





CHAPTER 1

The Game

YOU PLAY CLASSIC MONSTERS WHO SHARE A CASTLE IN the woods. Once a year, on Lantern Night, the town's festival, when everyone is in costume, you go down to steal what the castle needs. Get the shopping list home before dawn — and if the job goes wrong, outrun the mob before it corners you with pitchforks.

What a Session Is

Each session is one **raid** on a town you have never seen before. It is always the year's first stock-up: nothing from earlier raids carries over unless your group uses the optional campaign rules (Chapter 7). A raid runs **2–3 hours**.

Who Plays

3–5 players each play one of the eight **Entities**. One more person is the **Storyteller**, who runs the town, its villagers and the mob. The tone is horror-comedy for about 12 and up: real stakes, dark jokes, nothing gory.

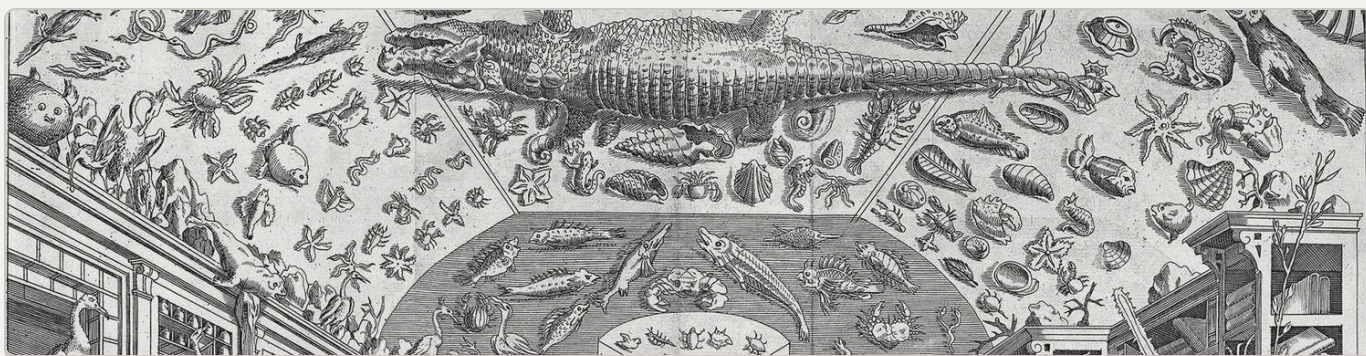
What You Need

- A set of polyhedral dice for each player: d4, d6, d8, d10 and d12.
- An Entity sheet for each player, and something to track Suspicion, Turns and the Lead.
- A town to raid: a premade one, a map, or one rolled on the random tables (Chapter 8).

THE RAID AT A GLANCE

- **Roll the shopping list:** one or two essentials, the rest extras.
- **Visit the town's locations** before dawn, getting past their obstacles and taking the loot.
- **Choose on every roll:** hide behind your Mask, or let the Monster out.
- **Watch Suspicion:** at the Limit, the whole town hunts you.
- **Get out of town** with the goods — or run for it, and don't get forked.





CHAPTER 2

The Entities

EIGHT ENTITIES SHARE THE CASTLE: DRACULA, Frankenstein's creature, the Mummy, the Werewolf, the Invisible Man, a Ghost, a Witch, and Jekyll & Hyde. Each player picks one. No two players in a party play the same Entity.

Five Traits

Every Entity has five **traits**:

TRAIT	FOR
Brawn	Force, lifting, breaking, fighting
Nimble	Climbing, running, slipping free
Sly	Sneaking, hiding, stealing
Charm	Talking, bluffing, passing as human
Wits	Noticing, knowing, figuring things out

Each trait is rated as a die. **Every Entity has one each of d12, d10, d8, d6 and d4**, placed differently: what one Entity does with a d12, another fumbles with a d4. Jekyll & Hyde has two forms on one sheet, each with its own arrangement of the same five dice.

The Mask and the Monster

Every roll adds a second die to the trait die. You choose which: the **Mask d6**, passing as human, or the **Monster d10**, letting the monster out. The Monster is stronger, but it risks Suspicion (Chapter 3). Every Entity has the same pair.

What Every Entity Has

- **Its dice arrangement.**
- **A signature ability**, and a second ability chosen as its **Gift**.
- **A Weakness**: something the town can use against it.
- **A Tell**: how it gives itself away.

Three Picks

Each Entity is premade, with three picks. Every pick has a marked default and a random-table entry, so a new player can skip the choices.

- **Gift**: one of three versions of the Entity's second ability.
- **Perk**: one of three passive edges; each bends one rule in one situation, every time.
- **Castle Duty**: one of the castle's household jobs, shared by all the Entities, each with a small edge tied to the shopping list. No two Entities in a party take the same Duty.

Charges

Every Entity has **3 charges**. One charge pays for one use of an ability. Charges refill once a year, at the castle; any you don't spend on a raid are lost, so spend them.

ABILITIES NEVER PASS AUTOMATICALLY

Every ability does one of four things: raise a die one size; use the ability's trait instead of the one called for; roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion; or open an approach nobody else can take. All of them still need a roll (Chapter 3).

Castle Duties

Every Entity keeps one job at the castle and shops for one kind of item. **At a location whose list item is your Duty's kind, your trait die is one size larger on your own rolls there;** it counts as that roll's one raise (Chapter 3). Each Entity's entry gives its default Duty; if two defaults clash in a party, the second player picks another or rolls a d6 again.

D6	DUTY	SHOPS FOR	WHERE IN TOWN	AT THE CASTLE
1	Cook	food and drink	the baker, the butcher, the tavern cellar	Keeps the castle fed and knows every kitchen door
2	Gardener	plants and seeds	the market garden, the florist, the seed merchant	Knows what grows where, and what's poisonous
3	Librarian	books and paper	the bookseller, the printer, the schoolhouse	Reads the town's notices and signs
4	Butler	silver, china and linen	the silversmith, the china shop	Knows how fine houses run, and where they keep the good spoons
5	Handyman	tools and hardware	the smithy, the ironmonger, the carpenter	Knows how locks and hinges work
6	Tailor	cloth and costumes	the draper, the tailor, the hatter	Keeps everyone's disguises in one piece

The Eight

Dracula



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d8** · Nimble **d10** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d12** · Wits **d4**

Mesmerise (signature): open an approach with Charm. He bends a mind with a look.

Gift: Shape of the Night. *Bat* (default): use Nimble instead of the trait called. He flits up to the window. · *Mist*: roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion. If he shows, it's only fog. · *Wolf*: raise a trait die one size. The strength and speed of a wolf.

Perk. *Hypnotic Eyes* (default): on Charm rolls, the Monster shows only if it beats your trait die by 2 or more. · *Old Money*: a Cost on a Charm roll is never Suspicion +1. · *Wall-Crawler*: in a chase you can always roll Nimble.

Castle Duty (default): Butler.

Weakness: Garlic (Always). Every kitchen in town has some, and the mob knows it.

Tell: No Reflection. A shop window shows everyone but him.

Frankenstein's Creature



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d12** · Nimble **d8** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d10**

Brute Force (signature): use Brawn instead of the trait called. Stronger than any man, it breaks what others pick.

Gift: Made, Not Born. *Mountain Stride* (default): open an approach with Nimble. He bounds over walls the way he crossed the glaciers. · *Hovel Watcher*: roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion. He learned to watch unseen. · *Book-Learned*: raise a trait die one size. He taught himself from books.

Perk. *Strong Back* (default): you carry a Huge piece alone. · *Tireless*: carrying doesn't make your Nimble smaller. · *Built to Last*: you slip free from the lock-up on a Success or a Cost.

Castle Duty (default): Handyman.

Weakness: Fire (Soon). Someone has to light the torches.

Tell: Head and Shoulders. He stands a head above the whole crowd, and no costume hides it.

The Mummy



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d10** · Nimble **d4** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d12**

Ancient Lore (signature): use Wits instead of the trait called. It knew this trick three thousand years ago.

Gift: Secrets of the Tomb. *Royal Bearing* (default): open an approach with Charm. They still bow to a pharaoh. · *Just a Costume*: roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion. On festival night, who'd believe a real one? · *Old Curse*: raise a trait die one size. A muttered curse, and the lock gives.

Perk. *Patience of Ages* (default): "lose a Turn" is never your Cost. · *Keeper of Treasures*: "drop an item" is never your Cost. · *Fear the Curse*: when you flee alone, the mob in your local chase is 1 easier: nobody wants to get too close.

Castle Duty (default): Librarian.

Weakness: A Loose Thread (Soon). Once someone grabs a loose end, it all starts to unravel.

Tell: Dust and Spice. A trail of dust and a smell of old spices wherever it walks.

The Werewolf



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d10** · Nimble **d12** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d8**

Good Dog (signature): roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion. If the wolf shows, the crowd sees a very large dog.

Gift: The Wolf Within. *Keen Nose* (default): use Wits instead of the trait called. It smells the way in. · *Through the Hedge*: open an approach with Brawn. It goes straight through. · *Howl*: raise a trait die one size. A howl that freezes the crowd for a moment.

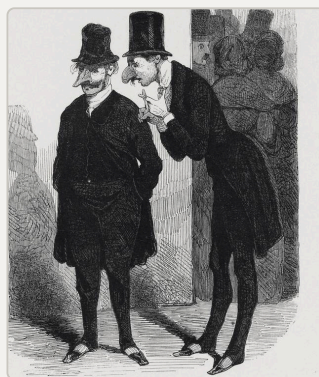
Perk. *Night Runner* (default): when you flee alone, your local chase starts at Lead 2. · *Shortcut*: the way out is 2 easier when you roll it. · *Fetch*: while you're in the final flight, it starts at Lead 3: you know the way home.

Castle Duty (default): Gardener.

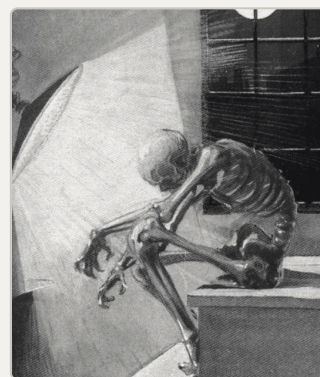
Weakness: Hounds (Soon). Someone lets the hunting dogs out.

Tell: Eyebrows That Meet. Brows that meet in the middle, and a little too much hair everywhere.

The Invisible Man



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d8** · Sly **d12** · Charm **d6** · Wits **d10**

Unseen (signature): roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion. When the monster shows, there's nothing to see.

Gift: A Scientist's Tricks. *Through the Gap* (default): open an approach with Nimble. He slips through as the door swings shut. · *Poltergeist*: raise a trait die one size. Things move by themselves, and everyone looks the other way. · *Work It Out*: use Wits instead of the trait called. A scientist's mind finds another way.

Perk. *Out of Sight* (default): trouble gets you caught only while you carry loot or furniture: they can't see you, but they can see a floating candlestick. · *Hidden Pockets*: captured, you keep what you carry. · *Light Step*: the loud way costs you no Suspicion.

Castle Duty (default): Tailor.

Weakness: Flour (Soon). Someone throws a bag of flour, and there he is.

Tell: Bandages and Goggles. A wrapped head, dark goggles, a false nose, and a sneeze from nowhere.

A Ghost



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d12** · Sly **d10** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d6**

Through the Wall (signature): open an approach with Sly, but not while you carry loot or furniture: nothing you carry passes through. It drifts in where there's no door.

Gift: Haunting. *Chill* (default): raise a trait die one size. A sudden cold, and fingers fumble. · *Whisper*: use Charm instead of the trait called. A voice in the ear. · *Fade*: roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion. A trick of the light.

Perk. *Spectral* (default): you get past group obstacles without rolling. · *Rattle*: the Monster showing on your roll is Suspicion +1, not +2: nobody takes rattling chains seriously. · *Already Dead*: cornered in a local chase, you lose your next Turn instead of being captured.

Castle Duty (default): Butler.

Weakness: Cold Iron (Always). Horseshoes, railings, a poker from the fire: every street has some.

Tell: Cold Spot. Candles gutter and breath fogs wherever it drifts.

A Witch



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d6** · Nimble **d4** · Sly **d10** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d12**

Hedge Spell (signature): raise a trait die one size, on any roll in the same place, hers or a friend's.

Gift: Witchcraft. *Broomstick* (default): open an approach with Sly. In over the rooftops, quiet as an owl. · *Black Cat*: roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion. Everyone blames the cat. · *A Potion for That*: use Wits instead of the trait called. There's a potion for everything.

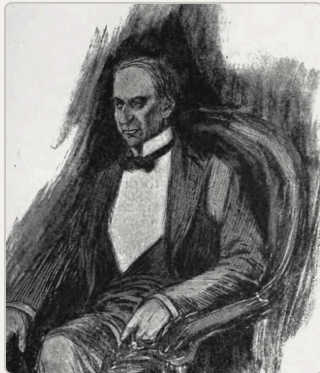
Perk. *Familiar's Warning* (default): when you arrive, a Tell check goes off only if a second d6 also rolls 4–6: the cat warns you. · *Fly by Night*: in a chase you can always roll Wits. · *Wise Woman*: a Cost on your Wits roll is never "lose a Turn".

Castle Duty (default): Cook.

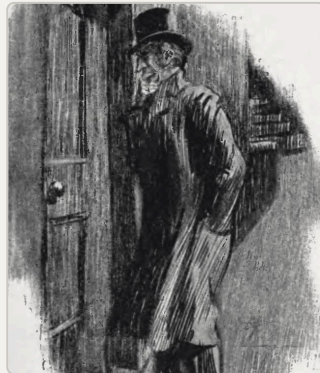
Weakness: Rowan (Soon). A sprig of rowan, the old charm against witches: somebody's grandmother always has one.

Tell: A Black Cat. A black cat follows her everywhere and stares at people.

Jekyll & Hyde



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Jekyll: Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d6** · Sly **d8** · Charm **d12** · Wits **d10**

Hyde: Brawn **d12** · Nimble **d10** · Sly **d8** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d6**

The Draught (signature): change form, Jekyll to Hyde or back; the new form lasts until the next draught. When the Monster shows on one of Jekyll's rolls, Hyde takes over, free.

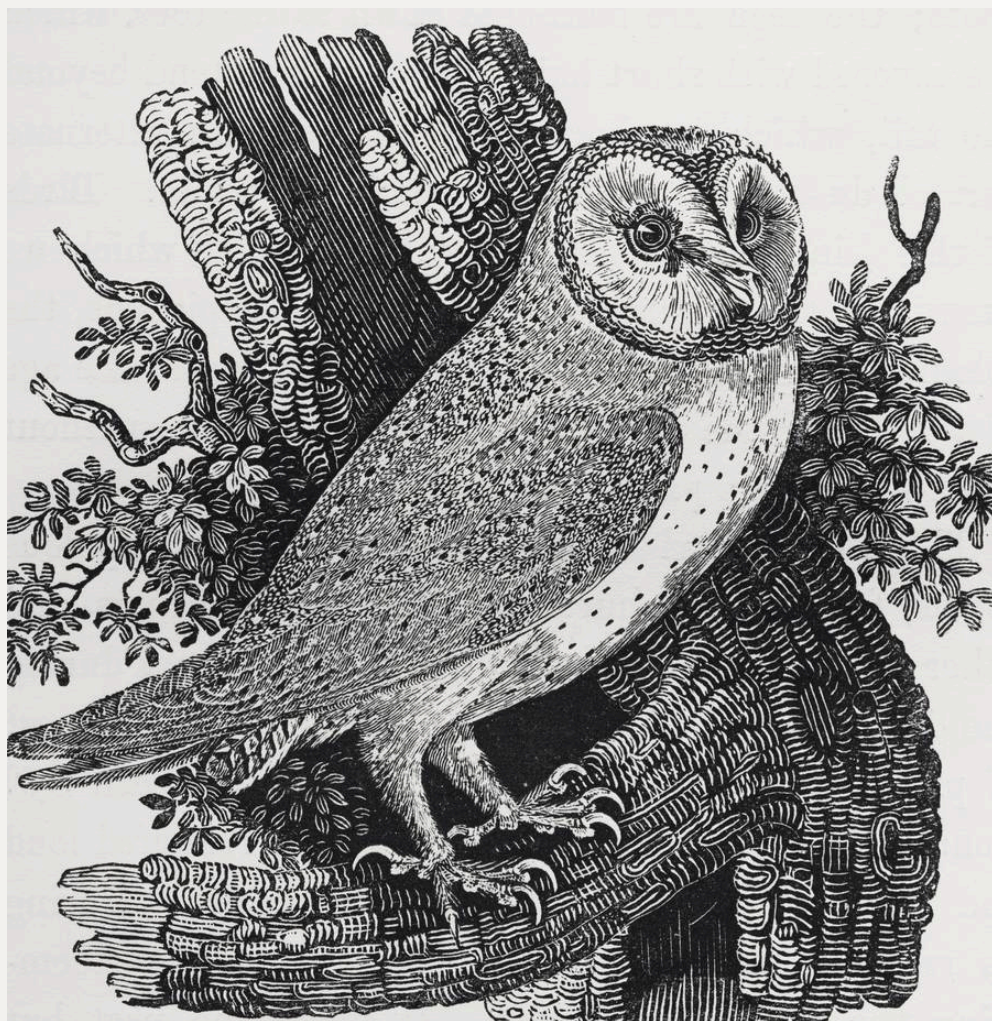
Gift: The Other Self. *Doctor's Bag* (default): raise a trait die one size. The right instrument for the job. · *Pillar of Society*: roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion. A respectable doctor having a funny turn (if the Monster shows, Hyde still takes over). · *Trample*: open an approach with Brawn. A d4 as Jekyll, a d12 as Hyde.

Perk. *Practised Hand* (default): changing back to Jekyll costs no charge. · *Steady Nerves*: Hyde takes over only if the Monster beats your trait die by 2 or more. · *Brute Strength*: as Hyde, carrying doesn't make your Nimble smaller.

Castle Duty (default): Librarian.

Weakness: A Familiar Face (Soon). Someone in the mob recognises the good doctor.

Tell: The Wrong Hand. One hand a gentleman's, the other hairy and knotted.





CHAPTER 3

Rolling the Dice

WHEN THE OUTCOME IS IN DOUBT, YOU ROLL TWO dice — your trait die and your Mask or Monster die — and add them together.

The Roll

1. **The obstacle sets the trait.** Each obstacle lists one or two traits that work, usually one of them the loud way (Suspicion +1 whatever the result, Chapter 5). Using any other trait needs an ability.
2. **Choose the second die:** the Mask d6 or the Monster d10.
3. **Roll both, add them,** and compare the total with the Difficulty: **6** easy, **8** standard, **10** hard, **12** daunting.

Results

- **Success:** the total meets the Difficulty. You do it.
- **Cost:** 1–2 short. You do it, at a cost the Storyteller picks: Suspicion +1, drop an item, lose a Turn (you skip your next action), or your next roll's trait die one size smaller. A dropped item falls where you are; picking it up costs your next action. The Storyteller never picks a Cost that costs nothing right then (say, a Suspicion +1 the roll already raised); “drop an item” drops one of your own items, never what this roll wins.
- **Trouble:** 3 or more short. It doesn't happen, Suspicion rises by 1, and if anyone is watching, you are caught (Chapter 6).
- **Critical:** a Success where both dice show the same face. In a chase it moves the Lead 2; anywhere else you get back one spent charge, never above your starting number.

The Monster Shows

If you rolled the Monster die and it came up **higher than your trait die**, the monster did the work and it showed: **Suspicion +2**. On a tie, or with the Mask, nothing shows.

Abilities

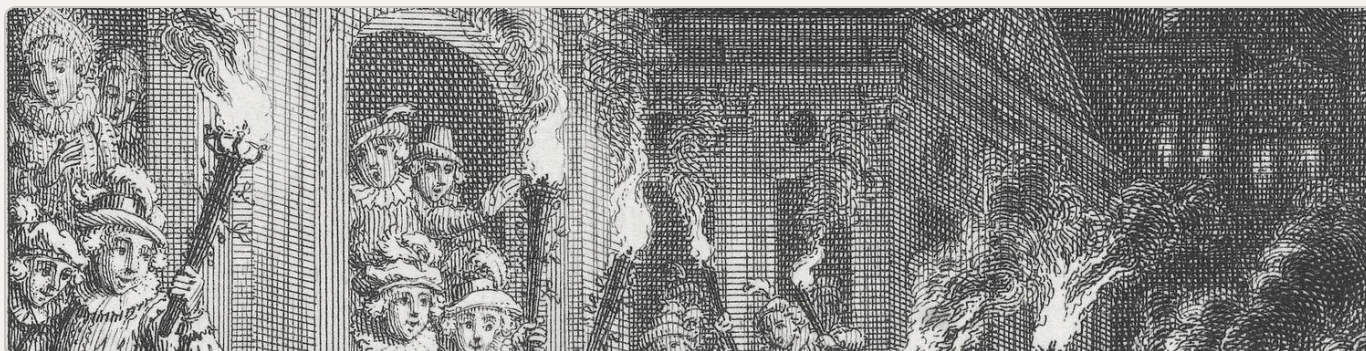
Using an ability costs one charge. It does one of four things:

- **Raise your trait die one size** (d4 → d6 → d8 → d10 → d12; a d12 can't go higher).
- **Use the ability's trait** instead of the one the obstacle calls for.
- **Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion:** if it shows, that raises nothing (Trouble or a Cost still counts).
- **Open an approach nobody else can take:** if the obstacle doesn't list the ability's trait, roll that trait at 2 lower Difficulty. Never in a chase. Only you get through, though the way out and a rescue work as usual, and a captive may open its own way out. You are watched as usual.

Spend abilities before you roll. An ability can help any Entity's roll at the same place, even past obstacles you haven't crossed; helping costs the charge, not your action. Several abilities may go on one roll, but it takes **at most one raise**, from any source, Castle Duty included. Raises and steps down cancel out. Nothing makes a die smaller than a d4: further steps down are lost.

Overdraw

At zero charges you can still use an ability, at a price: **Suspicion +2**. Once the hunt is on (Chapter 6), overdraw costs your Weakness instead.



CHAPTER 4

The Raid

THE RAID HAPPENS ON THE TOWN'S YEARLY FESTIVAL, **Lantern Night**, when everyone dresses up as a monster — which is why real ones can almost pass in the crowd. Dawn ends it.

The Shopping List

Before the raid, the Storyteller rolls the shopping list (Chapter 8; premade raids give their own): **4 items on Easy, 5 on Standard and Hard**. One or two are **essentials**; the rest are **extras**. Each item is one of six kinds (Chapter 2).

The Town

Every town is built from the same parts:

- **An obstacle:** one or two traits that work, and a Difficulty. It is **watched** or not.
- **A location:** 1–3 obstacles, crossed in order, guarding a list item; beat the last and it's in your hand. Its two ways in are two versions of the first obstacle (front door or back window, usually with different traits): the party picks one and keeps to it. It's watched if any obstacle is, either way in.
- **The way out** of town, always watched.

Turns

The night lasts **12 Turns**. The party starts at the edge of town, by the way out, and gets in without a roll. Each Turn, every Entity either makes one roll at its location or moves (any move takes one Turn unless the map says otherwise). Entities act one at a time, in any order, and each result (a move too) counts at once. Several may try the same obstacle in one Turn; each try risks Trouble. The party may split up. **Dawn** comes when the 12th Turn ends: anyone still in town runs for it in the final flight (Chapter 6).

Once anyone beats an obstacle (a Success or a Cost), it stays beaten for the whole party, unless it's marked **group** (a crowd, a guard who checks everyone): then each Entity who wants past rolls for itself. When several roll it in the same Turn (a **group check**), all declare their dice and abilities, then roll together; Suspicion rises only once, by the biggest trigger among their rolls.

Furniture

One piece of furniture or decor (they count the same; Chapter 8) stands at one of the list's locations, behind one extra obstacle, 2 harder (at most 12). Once that location's loot is in hand, the party may take on the extra obstacle and the piece. Bringing it home turns a Win into a **Grand Year** (Chapter 7).

Carrying

- **Bulky** pieces need one carrier, **Huge** pieces two.
- Carriers can't use the Mask die, and roll Nimble one size smaller.
- Huge pieces don't fit through small entrances.
- While carrying furniture, every move takes two Turns, and Suspicion rises by 1 at the end of each Turn.
- Taking a piece is free (no re-crossing); drop it any time. Loot has no limit: hand it to anyone in the same place, free.

Getting Out

The way out is one watched obstacle: **Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way**. The party leaves together: everyone not captured must be there, and one Entity rolls for all. A Success or a Cost gets everyone out, with nothing more to pay. On Trouble, Suspicion rises, the roller is caught (Chapter 6), and the party may try again next Turn.



CHAPTER 5

Suspicion

THE WHOLE TOWN SHARES ONE **SUSPICION** TRACK, from 0 up to a **Limit**: 12 on Easy and Standard, 15 on Hard.

What Raises It

TRIGGER	SUSPICION
Trouble	+1
The Monster shows	+2
Taking the loud way	+1
A Cost chosen as Suspicion	+1
Overdraw	+2
A Tell goes off	+1
Carrying furniture, each Turn	+1

THE LOUD WAY

When an obstacle lists a loud way and you take it, Suspicion rises by 1, whatever the result.

ONE ROLL, ONE RISE

One roll raises Suspicion only once, by its biggest trigger (overdraw included). Good results never lower it; only a few specific abilities or Perks can, within limits.

Tells

The first time anyone reaches each watched location (the way out and the lock-up included), check once, however the party has split: roll a d6, and on **4–6** a Tell goes off. Roll to see whose, among the Entities arriving: its Tell shows (Chapter 2), and Suspicion rises by 1.

Getting Caught

Trouble at a watched obstacle (it's the obstacle you roll that counts) gets the Entity caught, and a **local chase** starts (Chapter 6). Everyone who gets Trouble in one group check is caught together and flees together. Trouble where nobody is watching still raises Suspicion, but starts no chase.

At the Limit

When Suspicion reaches the Limit — or dawn comes with anyone still in town — the whole town hunts. Every Entity who isn't captured flees together in the **final flight** (Chapter 6). If the Limit comes during a local chase, that chase ends at once (even if the same round cornered you), and those Entities join the flight. From then on Suspicion stops. The track never goes past the Limit; extra points are lost.





CHAPTER 6

Chases and Getting Forked

THERE ARE TWO KINDS OF CHASE. GET CAUGHT DURING the raid and you run from a crowd; botch the whole job and the entire town turns out with pitchforks.

The Lead

Every chase uses a **Lead** track. Each round you roll against the mob's Difficulty:

- **Success:** Lead +1 (a Critical: +2).
- **Cost:** no change.
- **Trouble:** Lead -1.

Reach the escape number and you are clear. Reach 0 and you are cornered. In a chase the roll moves the Lead: a Cost costs nothing more, and Trouble doesn't start another chase. In a local chase, Trouble and the Monster showing still raise Suspicion (one roll, one rise); when several flee together, it rises once a round, by the biggest trigger.

The Ground

Each round, roll a d6 on the chase table at the end of this chapter. The result says which traits work this round for everyone in the chase, and always includes one that isn't Nimble.

Your Weakness

Once the mob brings your Weakness, you roll your trait one size smaller for the rest of the chase. Each Weakness (Chapter 2) says when the mob brings it:

- **Always:** from the first round of any chase.
- **Soon:** from the third round of any chase.
- **Dawn:** only in a final flight that dawn started, from its first round.

The Local Chase

When you are caught during the raid, you run. Your Lead starts at **1** and you escape at **4**. The mob's Difficulty is **10 plus half the Suspicion** (round down), at most 12, checked each round. You may use the Mask. In a local chase, abilities help only your own roll. The chase happens within the Turn it started; escape and you're back where you were caught, with your Turn used up. Entities caught together in one group check flee together on one shared Lead, which moves by the majority rule below, and are captured together if cornered.

Captured

Cornered in a local chase, you are **captured**, and the town takes back what you were carrying, furniture included: it's gone for the night. You are held at the town's **lock-up**.

- **Rescue:** the lock-up is an obstacle — Sly, or Brawn the loud way, always watched — at the lock-up Difficulty, with a new rescue obstacle for each capture. Getting there costs the party Turns. Beat it (a Success or a Cost) and every captive there is free and acts again next Turn; a rescuer's Trouble gets them caught as usual.
- **Slipping free:** once per Turn, from the Turn after its capture, a captive may try to slip free: Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way, at the lock-up Difficulty. Only a Success frees you; a Cost does nothing, and on Trouble Suspicion rises but no chase starts. A freed Entity acts again next Turn.
- **Left behind:** anyone still held when the party leaves town is left behind (Chapter 7).

The Final Flight

At the Limit, or at dawn, every Entity who isn't captured flees together. The Lead starts at **2** and the party escapes at **6**. The mob's Difficulty is set by the town's difficulty (Chapter 8) and doesn't change with the size of the party. Everyone flees together, so abilities can help anyone's roll.

THE MAJORITY RULE

Everyone rolls each round. If Successes outnumber Trouble, the Lead rises by 1; if Trouble outnumbers Successes, it falls by 1; otherwise it stays. A Critical counts as two Successes.

Escape and you are home with the goods. Get cornered and the party is **forked**: the monsters are killed and the raid is lost.

Once the Hunt Is On

From the moment the final flight begins, Suspicion stops and **the Mask is off**: everyone rolls the Monster die. You may still overdraw, but your Weakness is then in play from your next roll to the end of the flight, and while your Weakness is in play, however it came, you can't overdraw.

The Chase Table

D6	THE GROUND	TRAITS THAT WORK
1	The crowded square. Lose yourself in the crowd, or bluff your way through.	Sly, Charm
2	Back alleys. Duck, dodge, double back.	Nimble, Sly
3	The market stalls. Overturn a cart, vault a stall.	Brawn, Nimble
4	Over the rooftops. Climb, jump, find a way down.	Nimble, Wits
5	The festival parade. Join in: you're in costume, after all.	Charm, Sly
6	A dead end. Break through, or think fast.	Brawn, Wits





CHAPTER 7

How the Year Went

WHEN THE PARTY IS OUT OF TOWN — OR THE MOB has the last word — look at what came home.

RESULT	WHEN
Grand Year	A Win, plus at least one piece of furniture or decor
Win	Every essential, and at most one extra missing
Partial	Less than a Win, with at least half the list home (missing an essential is at best a Partial)
Bust	Less than half the list home
Forked	Cornered in the final flight: the session ends

Left Behind

Each Entity left behind in the lock-up drops the result one step: a Grand Year becomes a Win, a Win a Partial, a Partial a Bust. Bust is as low as it goes, short of being forked.

The Epilogue

The result decides the epilogue — how the castle's year goes — and nothing else. Nothing carries over to the next raid. Read the line for the result, then one line for each kind of item on the list that didn't come home.

RESULT	THE YEAR
Grand Year	A year of plenty. The new piece goes in the great hall, and everyone pretends it was always there.
Win	Full larders, warm fires. The castle creaks happily through another year.
Partial	The castle gets by, just. Someone has to sleep in the draughty tower.
Bust	A long, thin year, and a lot of arguing about whose fault it was.
Forked	The town tells the story for years. Next Lantern Night, the bells ring a little louder.

MISSING	WHAT THE CASTLE WENT WITHOUT
Food and drink	Turnip soup every night until spring.
Plants and seeds	Nothing grows but nettles, and the nettles win.
Books and paper	Nobody knows what the town is saying, or what day it is.
Silver, china and linen	Dinner is served on old coffin lids.
Tools and hardware	Every door in the castle creaks, sticks or falls off.
Cloth and costumes	Next year's disguises are held together with string and hope.

OPTIONAL: CAMPAIGN PLAY

For groups who play several raids: each piece of furniture or decor brought home becomes a **castle upgrade**. In every later raid, each upgrade gives one Entity of the players' choice **one extra charge**. The castle holds **three upgrades** at most; bringing home a fourth replaces one of them. Nothing negative carries over, and the Entities themselves don't change.



PART TWO

Running the Game

*For the Storyteller: building a town, setting its difficulty,
and running the villagers and the mob.*





CHAPTER 8

Building a Town

EVERY RAID IS ON A NEW TOWN. THERE ARE THREE ways to build one, all from the same parts — obstacles, locations, and the way out.

Three Ways

- **A premade raid:** a fixed set of locations and obstacles, ready to run. Chapter 9 has three, one for each difficulty, each with its map.
- **A map:** a set of locations the party picks its route through.
- **The random tables:** roll the locations, obstacles, loot and villagers. A ceiling on the hardest obstacles keeps a rolled town playing at the difficulty it promises.

OBSTACLES

Give each obstacle one or two traits that work. When there are two, usually one is the loud way. Mark which obstacles are watched — Trouble there gets an Entity caught — and which are group obstacles that each Entity must roll for itself. Give each location two versions of its first obstacle, with different traits: its two ways in.

Lantern Night

On the festival night, everyone dresses up as a monster and carries a lantern to keep the real ones away. Every town keeps it its own way: roll a d6 or pick a custom for each town. Customs are flavour, not rules.

D6	LOCAL CUSTOM
1	Turnip lanterns in every window.
2	A costume parade through the square at midnight.
3	A masked ball at the mayor's house.
4	Pies left on doorsteps "for the wanderers".
5	A bonfire in the square, and a straw monster burned at dawn.
6	Bells rung every hour to keep the real monsters away. They never work.

Rolling a Town

1. **Locations:** one for each item on the list, at one of the three places its kind is found (Chapter 2): roll a d3 or pick.
2. **Obstacles:** roll a d20 for how many each location has.
3. **Each obstacle** (both versions of the first, its two ways in, and the furniture's extra one, 2 harder): the obstacle table for what it is, a d20 for its Difficulty, a d10 for whether it's watched. For the second way in, roll again until its quiet way is a different trait.
4. **The ceiling:** at most one Difficulty 12 in an Easy or Standard town, two in a Hard town. Reroll any extra.

ROLL	EASY	STANDARD	HARD
Obstacles at a location (d20)	1–10: one · 11–18: two · 19–20: three	1–6: one · 7–15: two · 16–20: three	1–4: one · 5–13: two · 14–20: three
Difficulty (d20)	1–3: 6 · 4–13: 8 · 14–19: 10 · 20: 12	1–3: 6 · 4–13: 8 · 14–19: 10 · 20: 12	1–8: 8 · 9–17: 10 · 18–20: 12
Watched (d10)	1–4	1–5	1–6

The Obstacle Table

The quiet way gets past without a fuss; the loud way works too, but Suspicion rises by 1 whatever the result (Chapter 5). At a *group* obstacle, everyone there rolls for themselves (Chapter 4).

D20	OBSTACLE	QUIET WAY	LOUD WAY
1	A heavy cellar trapdoor	Brawn	—
2	A tug-of-war across the lane (<i>group</i>)	Brawn	—
3	A cart blocking the alley	Brawn	Nimble (scramble over the load)
4	A bolted back gate	Brawn (lift it off its hinges)	Charm (shout “Delivery!” until someone opens it)
5	A high garden wall	Nimble	Brawn (through the gate, lock and all)
6	A shuttered window	Nimble	Brawn (force the shutters)
7	The rooftops (<i>group</i>)	Nimble	—
8	A rickety drainpipe	Nimble	—
9	A locked front door	Sly (pick the lock)	Brawn (kick it in)
10	A nosy neighbour at her window	Sly	Wits (a false alarm: “Your cat’s on the roof!”)
11	A crowded shop floor (<i>group</i>)	Sly	—
12	A muddy yard full of geese	Sly	Nimble (run for it, honking)
13	The shopkeeper behind the counter	Charm	Sly (snatch it from under her nose)
14	A guard dog	Charm (good dog)	Nimble (outrun it, barking)
15	A doorman checking invitations	Charm	Wits (a forged invitation that fools nobody for long)
16	Children in costumes who want a closer look (<i>group</i>)	Charm	—
17	A locked strongbox	Wits (work out the catch)	Charm (sweet-talk the clerk into opening it)
18	A dark, cluttered back room	Wits	Sly (rummage through everything)
19	The night watchman on his round	Wits (time his round)	—
20	A maze of festival stalls (<i>group</i>)	Wits	—

Difficulty

Choose Easy, Standard or Hard. The difficulty sets these numbers:

	EASY	STANDARD	HARD
Shopping list (essentials)	4 (1)	5 (1–2)	5 (2)
Obstacle Difficulties: share of 6 · 8 · 10 · 12	15 · 50 · 30 · 5%	15 · 50 · 30 · 5%	0 · 40 · 45 · 15%
Suspicion Limit	12	12	15
The way out: Difficulty	6	8	10
The final flight: mob Difficulty	10	11	11
The lock-up: Difficulty	10	10	12

On every difficulty: 3 charges per Entity, 12 Turns, overdraw +2 Suspicion; a local chase starts at Lead 1 and escapes at 4 against a mob of 10 plus half the Suspicion (at most 12); the final flight starts at Lead 2 and escapes at 6.

The Shopping List

For each item, roll a d6 for its kind and a d6 for the item itself; roll again on a repeat. The first items rolled are the essentials (how many: the difficulty table above; on Standard, roll any die: odd, one; even, two). Only the kind matters to the rules: it decides which Castle Duty gets its edge there.

D6	KIND	THE ITEM (SECOND D6)
1	Food and drink	1 a wheel of strong cheese · 2 a side of bacon · 3 a cask of red wine (“for the guests”) · 4 a sack of flour · 5 a jar of honey · 6 the wedding cake in the baker’s window
2	Plants and seeds	1 seed potatoes · 2 a pot of nightshade (purely ornamental) · 3 rose bushes for the graveyard · 4 turnip seed for next year’s lanterns · 5 a crate of lilies · 6 mushroom spawn for the cellar
3	Books and paper	1 this week’s newspapers · 2 black-edged writing paper · 3 a cookbook “for the guests” · 4 ink and sealing wax · 5 an almanac with next year’s moons · 6 a book of etiquette
4	Silver, china and linen	1 the silver spoons · 2 a tea service · 3 bed linen · 4 a lace tablecloth · 5 a pair of candlesticks · 6 a gravy boat
5	Tools and hardware	1 a box of nails · 2 a new lock for the dungeon · 3 hinges that creak properly · 4 a lamp and a can of oil · 5 a coil of rope · 6 a length of good chain
6	Cloth and costumes	1 a bolt of black velvet · 2 bandages, lots · 3 a top hat · 4 a new cape · 5 knitting wool · 6 boots in a very large size

The Furniture

Roll a d6 for the piece of furniture or decor standing at one of the list’s locations (Chapter 4).

D6	THE PIECE	SIZE
1	A wingback armchair	Bulky
2	A gilt mirror	Bulky
3	A suit of armour	Bulky
4	A stuffed bear	Bulky
5	A grandfather clock	Huge
6	A four-poster bed	Huge

The Villagers

Whenever a watched obstacle needs a face, or a Cost needs someone to cause it, roll who it is and what they’re doing.

D6	WHO	WHAT THEY’RE DOING
1	The baker’s wife	Looking for a lost cat
2	The night watchman	Tipsy from the cider
3	A gang of children	Judging the costume contest
4	The vicar	Carrying a lantern and a pitchfork “for the parade”
5	The mayor, in his best costume	Gossiping, loudly
6	Old Granny Mott, who has seen it all before	Practising the bells

Running the Villagers and the Mob

Villagers and witnesses. Everyone in town is in costume and in a good mood, and they see what they expect to see. A watched obstacle means someone is looking: roll a villager to give them a face. Play the town busy and cheerful, until it isn’t.

Choosing Costs. Pick the one that hurts most right now, but never one that costs nothing (Chapter 3). A lost Turn bites near dawn, a smaller die before a hard roll, “drop an item” when someone carries loot, Suspicion +1 near the Limit. Always say what happened: the baker’s wife looks twice.

Suspicion. Keep the track where everyone can see it, and let the town's mood follow it: whispers, then pointing, then torches.

The mob. Once the hunt is on, the mob is like the weather: always there, always closer. Read the ground off the chase table every round. When a Weakness comes into play (Chapter 6), make it a moment.

The lock-up. Capture is a setback, not an ending. The captive can try to slip free every Turn, and the others can come for them (Chapter 6). Keep the captive's player busy: let them voice a jailer or a villager.

Pacing. Count the Turns aloud, and warn when three are left. A raid should fit in two to three hours.





CHAPTER 9

Three Towns

T HREE TOWNS READY TO RAID, ONE FOR EACH difficulty, each with its list, locations, obstacles, furniture, Lantern Night custom, villagers, numbers and map.

A location's first two rows are its two ways in: the party picks one and keeps to it. The furniture's obstacle is already 2 harder. On the map, an eye marks a watched location, a star the furniture. Any move takes one Turn.

EASY **Puddlecombe** *A sleepy village that has never had a real monster.*

Lantern Night: Pies left on doorsteps “for the wanderers”.

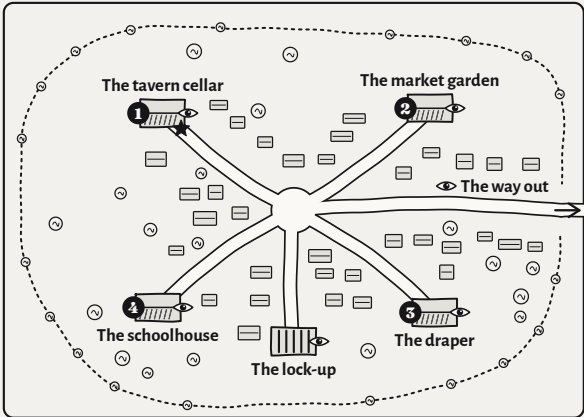
The shopping list (4 items):

1. **A wheel of strong cheese** (essential)
2. Seed potatoes
3. Knitting wool
4. An almanac with next year's moons

The furniture: a stuffed bear (Bulky), at the tavern cellar (1).

Villagers: the baker's wife (looking for a lost cat); the night watchman (tipsy from the cider).

Easy: Suspicion Limit 12 · the way out 6 · the lock-up 10 · the final flight's mob 10.



LOCATION · OBSTACLE		QUIET WAY	LOUD WAY	DIFFICULTY
1 The tavern cellar: a wheel of strong cheese (food and drink) · essential				
WAY IN	A locked front door <i>watched</i>	Sly (pick the lock)	Brawn (kick it in)	8
OR	A heavy cellar trapdoor <i>watched</i>	Brawn	—	8
THEN	A dark, cluttered back room	Wits	Sly (rummage through everything)	6
FURNITURE	A guard dog	Charm (good dog)	Nimble (outrun it, barking)	10
2 The market garden: seed potatoes (plants and seeds)				
WAY IN	A high garden wall	Nimble	Brawn (through the gate, lock and all)	8
OR	A muddy yard full of geese	Sly	Nimble (run for it, honking)	6
THEN	The night watchman on his round <i>watched</i>	Wits (time his round)	—	8
3 The draper: knitting wool (cloth and costumes)				
WAY IN	The shopkeeper behind the counter <i>watched</i>	Charm	Sly (snatch it from under her nose)	8
OR	A shuttered window	Nimble	Brawn (force the shutters)	10
4 The schoolhouse: an almanac with next year's moons (books and paper)				
WAY IN	A bolted back gate	Brawn (lift it off its hinges)	Charm (shout “Delivery!” until someone opens it)	8
OR	A rickety drainpipe	Nimble	—	10
THEN	Children in costumes who want a closer look (group) <i>watched</i>	Charm	—	8

STANDARD **Thistlewick** *A market town proud of its festival.*

Lantern Night: A costume parade through the square at midnight.

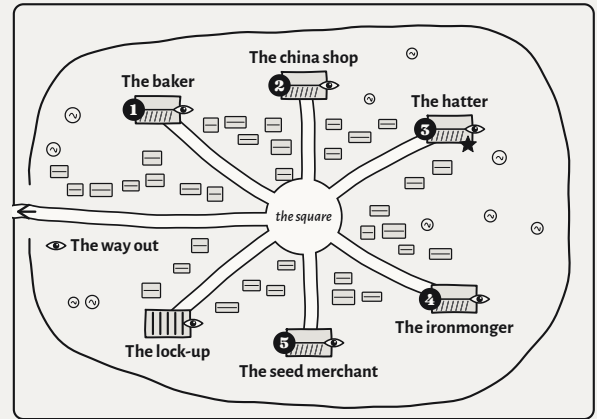
The shopping list (5 items):

1. **The wedding cake in the baker's window** (essential)
2. **A tea service** (essential)
3. A top hat
4. A coil of rope
5. Turnip seed for next year's lanterns

The furniture: a gilt mirror (Bulky), at the hatter (3).

Villagers: the mayor, in his best costume (judging the costume contest); the vicar (carrying a lantern and a pitchfork "for the parade").

Standard: Suspicion Limit 12 · the way out 8 · the lock-up 10 · the final flight's mob 11.



LOCATION · OBSTACLE	QUIET WAY	LOUD WAY	DIFFICULTY
1 The baker: the wedding cake in the baker's window (food and drink) · essential			
WAY IN A crowded shop floor (group) <i>watched</i>	Sly	—	8
OR A shuttered window	Nimble	Brawn (force the shutters)	8
THEN The shopkeeper behind the counter <i>watched</i>	Charm	Sly (snatch it from under her nose)	8
2 The china shop: a tea service (silver, china and linen) · essential			
WAY IN A locked front door	Sly (pick the lock)	Brawn (kick it in)	8
OR A bolted back gate <i>watched</i>	Brawn (lift it off its hinges)	Charm (shout "Delivery!" until someone opens it)	10
THEN A dark, cluttered back room	Wits	Sly (rummage through everything)	8
3 The hatter: a top hat (cloth and costumes)			
WAY IN A nosy neighbour at her window <i>watched</i>	Sly	Wits (a false alarm: "Your cat's on the roof!")	8
OR The rooftops (group)	Nimble	—	10
FURNITURE A guard dog <i>watched</i>	Charm (good dog)	Nimble (outrun it, barking)	10
4 The ironmonger: a coil of rope (tools and hardware)			
WAY IN A cart blocking the alley	Brawn	Nimble (scramble over the load)	6
OR A high garden wall	Nimble	Brawn (through the gate, lock and all)	8
THEN A locked strongbox <i>watched</i>	Wits (work out the catch)	Charm (sweet-talk the clerk into opening it)	8
5 The seed merchant: turnip seed for next year's lanterns (plants and seeds)			
WAY IN A maze of festival stalls (group)	Wits	—	8
OR A muddy yard full of geese	Sly	Nimble (run for it, honking)	6
THEN The night watchman on his round <i>watched</i>	Wits (time his round)	—	10

An Example of Play

Four players raid Thistlewick: Dracula, the Witch, Frankenstein's creature and the Werewolf, with their default picks (Butler, Cook, Handyman and Gardener). Suspicion starts at 0; the Limit is 12.

Turn 1. The party splits. The Witch and the Werewolf head for the baker, where the Witch's Cook duty gives her an edge; Dracula and the creature take the china shop, Dracula's as Butler. Both are watched, so the Storyteller makes a **Tell check** at each: a 2 and a 1, no Tells.

Turn 2. At the baker, the party takes the shuttered window. The Werewolf rolls Nimble d12 with the **Mask**: 10 + 4 = 14 against 8, a Success. The window is open for both of them

now, so the Witch goes on to the shopkeeper (Charm, 8, watched). Her Charm d8 is a d10 here (her duty's raise), and she lets the **Monster** out for the bigger die: 1 + 4 = 5. That is 3 short, **Trouble**, and the Monster's 4 beat her trait die's 1, so it showed. One roll, one rise: Suspicion goes up by the bigger trigger, to 2. The shopkeeper was watching, so the Witch is caught.

She runs. Her **Lead** starts at 1, and the mob is 10 + half the Suspicion: 11. Round 1, a dead end: Wits d12 and the Monster, 12 + 3 = 15, Lead 2. Round 2, another dead end: 2 + 9 = 11, Lead 3, but the Monster showed: Suspicion 4, and the mob is now 12. Round 3, the festival parade, and out comes a sprig of rowan: her Weakness makes her Sly d10 a d8. She spends a charge on her Hedge Spell to raise it back and rolls

5 + 7 = 12: Lead 4, and she escapes. The Monster showed again: Suspicion 6. She is back at the baker, her Turn used up.

At the china shop, Dracula picks the lock of the front door with the Mask: Sly d6, a d8 with his Butler duty, 7 + 2 = 9 against 8. The creature takes the back room with Wits d10 and the Mask: 5 + 2 = 7, one short, a **Cost**. He has the tea service; the Storyteller picks the Cost. Dropping an item would cost nothing (he carries only what this roll won), so it's Suspicion +1: a teacup smashes. Suspicion 7.

Turn 3. The Witch tries the shopkeeper again, and the Werewolf spends a charge on Good Dog for her: she rolls the Monster without risking Suspicion. 7 + 4 = 11, a Success, and the wedding cake is hers. Dracula and the creature move on to the ironmonger, which is watched: the Tell check is a 4, and a second roll picks the creature, who stands a head above the crowd. Suspicion 8.

Three Turns gone, nine to go. Both essentials are in hand, but Suspicion is 8 of 12: from here on, every Monster counts.

HARD Gallowsmere *A walled town that remembers last year.*

Lantern Night: Bells rung every hour to keep the real monsters away. They never work.

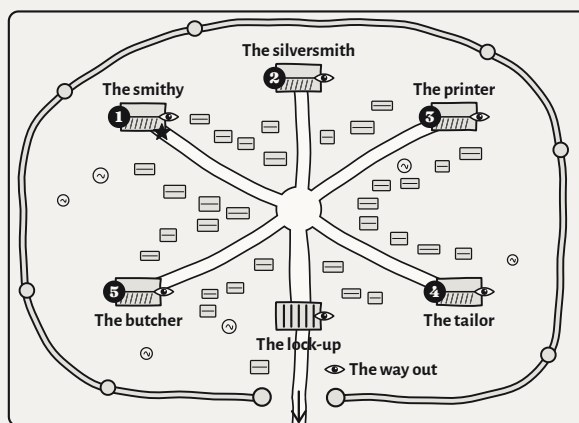
The shopping list (5 items):

1. **A new lock for the dungeon** (essential)
2. **The silver spoons** (essential)
3. Black-edged writing paper
4. Bandages, lots
5. A side of bacon

The furniture: a suit of armour (Bulky), at the smithy (1).

Villagers: old Granny Mott, who has seen it all before (practising the bells); a gang of children (gossiping, loudly).

Hard: Suspicion Limit 15 · the way out 10 · the lock-up 12 · the final flight's mob 11.



LOCATION · OBSTACLE	QUIET WAY	LOUD WAY	DIFFICULTY
1 The smithy: a new lock for the dungeon (tools and hardware) · essential			
WAY IN A bolted back gate <i>watched</i>	Brawn (lift it off its hinges)	Charm (shout "Delivery!" until someone opens it)	10
OR A high garden wall <i>watched</i>	Nimble	Brawn (through the gate, lock and all)	8
THEN The night watchman on his round <i>watched</i>	Wits (time his round)	—	10
FURNITURE A heavy cellar trapdoor	Brawn	—	12
2 The silversmith: the silver spoons (silver, china and linen) · essential			
WAY IN A locked front door <i>watched</i>	Sly (pick the lock)	Brawn (kick it in)	10
OR A shuttered window <i>watched</i>	Nimble	Brawn (force the shutters)	8
THEN A guard dog <i>watched</i>	Charm (good dog)	Nimble (outrun it, barking)	8
THEN A locked strongbox	Wits (work out the catch)	Charm (sweet-talk the clerk into opening it)	10
3 The printer: black-edged writing paper (books and paper)			
WAY IN A nosy neighbour at her window <i>watched</i>	Sly	Wits (a false alarm: "Your cat's on the roof!")	8
OR The rooftops (group)	Nimble	—	10
THEN A dark, cluttered back room	Wits	Sly (rummage through everything)	10
4 The tailor: bandages, lots (cloth and costumes)			
WAY IN A doorman checking invitations <i>watched</i>	Charm	Wits (a forged invitation that fools nobody for long)	10
OR A rickety drainpipe	Nimble	—	8
THEN A crowded shop floor (group) <i>watched</i>	Sly	—	10
5 The butcher: a side of bacon (food and drink)			
WAY IN A muddy yard full of geese <i>watched</i>	Sly	Nimble (run for it, honking)	8
OR A cart blocking the alley <i>watched</i>	Brawn	Nimble (scramble over the load)	10
THEN The shopkeeper behind the counter <i>watched</i>	Charm	Sly (snatch it from under her nose)	10
THEN A tug-of-war across the lane (group)	Brawn	—	12

Once a year, the monsters go shopping.

Every year, on Lantern Night, the whole town dresses up as monsters. Every year, a few real ones walk in with them.

You play Dracula, Frankenstein's creature, the Mummy, the Werewolf, the Invisible Man, a Ghost, a Witch or Jekyll & Hyde: housemates in a crumbling castle with a shopping list to fill before dawn. Hide behind the Mask, or let the Monster out and risk the town's Suspicion. Grab what the castle needs, and maybe a nice armchair. And if it all goes wrong, run, because the mob has pitchforks.



For 3–5 players and a Storyteller · 2–3 hours · ages 12+ · play online with the Foundry Virtual Tabletop system

DON'T GET FORKED · VERSION 0.1